



THE CHORUS

George Frideric Handel

Solomon

*Oratorio in three movements
sung in English and performed
in a historical setting*

Egede Deborah Michael – soprano (*Queen*)
Nengimonyu Susan Okara – soprano (*Queen of Sheba*)
Gozie Paschal Chima – altus (*Solomon1*)
Whyte Joseph Ezekiel – altus (*Solomon2*)
Zigwai Ezra/Millicent Jagusa – soprano (*First Harlot*)
Rose Ozien Nwachi – soprano (*Second Harlot*)
Raphael Ipalibo/Honest Uzorchukwu Onunwa – tenor (*Zadok*)
Chukwuka Ozomata/Budubueze Ozuru – bass (*Levite*)
The Chorus Abuja Choir
Accompanists: Kenneth Elekwachi, Seyi Aiyinde, Iheanyi
Owutu
Conductor: Kelechi Nnam

*A concert held at
Nigerian Society of Engineers Hall
1012, Sani Abacha Way, CBD, Abuja
Nov. 16th, 2025*



Handel's **Solomon**

Soloists

Egede Deborah Michael – soprano (Queen)
Nengimonyu Susan Okara – soprano (Queen of Sheba)
Gozie Paschal Chima – altus (Solomon1)
Whyte Joseph Ezekiel – altus (Solomon2)
Zigwai Ezra (First Harlot)
Rose Ozien Nwachi – soprano (Second Harlot)
Millicent Jagusa – soprano (First Harlot)
Raphael Ipalibo – tenor (Zadok)
Honest Uzorchukwu Onunwa – tenor (Zadok)
Chukwuka Ozomata – bass (Levite)
Budubueze Ozuru – bass (Levite)

Accompanists

Concertmaster
Kelechi Nnam

**Violins, Violas, Violoncelli, Doublebasses,
Flutes, Oboes, Bassoons & Organ (synth)**
Kenneth Elekwachi, Seyi Aiyinde, Iheanyi Owutu

Trumpet 1
Miracle Onyekachukwu

Trumpet 2
Onyekachi Daniel Uzoma

French Horn
Emmanuel Damilare

Trombone
Maiwada Atagozawanyi Zacchaeus

Timpani
Akpan Ubong

The Chorus Abuja Choir

featuring

The Chorus Abuja Choir · Choir I

Soprano I

*Zigwai Ezra, Gold Omeire, Oscar Patrick, Precious Oluchi
Kanu, Millicent Jagusa, Joy Asekhamen, Nengimonyu
Susan Okara, Egede Deborah Michael*

Alto I

*Amarachi Okpara, Chidera Nnam, Pamilerin Damilola
Ayeni*

Tenor I

*Raphael Ipalibo, Honest Uzorchukwu Onunwa, Felix
Francis*

Bass I

*Alison Chinedum Samuel, Chidi Amadi, Kenneth
Chukwuemerie Ndubuisi, Isaac Oburu*

The Chorus Abuja Choir · Choir II

Soprano II

*Rose Ozien Nwachi, Whyte Joseph Ezikie, Ezinne Uwazie,
Deinma Soseipiriala Ogan*

Alto II

*Ngozi Owutu, Biebele Friday Eritoru, Gozie Paschal Chima,
Tochukwu Uche*

Tenor II

Victor Ifenwanta, Daniel Chuks, Agbaje Jude

Bass II

*Chukwuka Ozomata, Emmanuel Oghenemaga,
Budubueze Ozuru*

Media

Uzor Godswill Ahanotu

Accompanists

*Kenneth Elekwachi
Seyi Aiyinde
Iheanyi Owutu*

Conductor

Kelechi Nnam

GEORGE FRIDERIC HANDEL (1685-1759)

SOLOMON • ACT I

Scene I

Solomon, Zadok, Priests and Israelites

CHORUS OF PRIESTS

*Your harps and cymbals sound
To great Jehovah's praise;
Unto the Lord of Hosts
Your willing voices raise.*

Levite

*Praise ye the Lord for all his mercies past,
Whose truth, whose justice will for ever last.*

CHORUS OF PRIESTS

*With pious heart, and holy tongue,
Resound your Maker's name,
Till distant nations catch the song,
And glow with holy flame.*

Solomon

*Almighty pow'r! who rul'st the earth and skies,
And bade gay order from confusion rise;
Whose gracious hand reliev'd Thy slave distress'd,
With splendour cloath'd him, and with knowledge bless'd;
Thy finish'd Temple with Thy presence grace,
And shed Thy heav'nly glories o'er the place.*

Zadok

*Imperial Solomon, thy pray'rs are heard.
See! from the op'ning skies
Descending flames involve the sacrifice;
And lo! within the sacred dome
That gleamy light,
Profusely bright,
Declares the Lord of Hosts is come.
Sacred raptures cheer my breast,
Rushing tides of hallow'd zeal,
Joys too fierce to be express'd,
In this swelling heart I feel.
Warm enthusiastic fires
In my panting bosom roll,
Hope of bliss, that ne'er expires,
Dawns upon my ravish'd soul.
Sacred raptures cheer my breast,
Rushing tides of hallow'd zeal,
Joys too fierce to be express'd,
In this swelling heart I feel.*

CHORUS OF ISRAELITES

*Throughout the land Jehovah's praise record,
For full of pow'r and mercy is the Lord.*

Solomon

*Bless'd be the Lord, who look'd with gracious eyes
Upon his vassals' humble sacrifice,
And has with an approving smile
My work o'erpaid, and grac'd the pile.
What though I trace each herb and flow'r,
That drink the morning dew,
Did I not own Jehovah's pow'r,
How vain were all I knew!
Say what's the rest but empty boast,
The pedant's idle claim,
Who having all the substance lost
Attempts to grasp a name?
What though: (da capo)*

Scene II

To them the queen

Solomon

*And see my Queen, my wedded love,
You soon my tenderness shall prove;
A palace shall erect its head,
Of cedar built, with gold bespread;
Me thinks the work is now begun,
The ax resounds on Lebanon,
And see, bedeck'd with canvas wings,
The dancing vessel lightly springs,
While Ophir's mines, well-pleas'd, disclose
The wealth that in their entrails glows.*

Queen

*Bless'd the day when first my eyes
Saw the wisest of the wise!
Bless'd the day when I was led
To ascend the nuptial bed!
But completely bless'd the day,
On my bosom as he lay,
When he call'd my charms divine,
Vowing to be only mine.
Bless'd the day: (da capo)*

Solomon

*Thou fair inhabitant of Nile,
Rejoice thy lover with a smile!*

Queen

*Oh monarch! with each virtue bless'd,
The brightest star that gilds the east;
No joy I know beneath the sun,
But what's compris'd in Solomon.
With thee, how quickly fled the winter's night,
And short is summer's length of light.*

DUET**Queen**

*Welcome as the dawn of day
To the pilgrim on his way,
Whom the darkness caus'd to stay,
is my lovely king to me.*

Solomon

*Myrtle grove, or rosy shade,
Breathing odours through the glade
To refresh the village maid,
Yields in sweets, my queen, to thee*

Zadork

*Vain are the transient beauties of the face,
Where virtue fails to animate each grace;
Bright and more bright her radiant face
appears, Nor dreads the canker'd tooth of
rolling years: O'er such a partner comfort
spreads her wing, And all our life is one
perpetual spring.*

*Indulge thy faith and wedded truth
With the fair partner of thy youth;
She's ever constant, ever kind,
Like the young roe, or loving hind.*

Solomon

*My blooming fair, come, come away,
My love admits of no delay.*

*Haste, haste to the cedar grove,
Where fragrant spices bloom, And am'rous
turtles love, Beneath the pleasing gloom.
While thinking down the hill, Avoiding
hateful day, The little murm'ring rill
In whispers glides away. Haste, haste...*

Queen

*When thou art absent from my sight,
The court I shun, and loathe the light.
With thee th'unshelter'd moor I'd tread,
Nor once of fate complain;
Though burning suns flash'd round my head,
and cleav'd he barren plain.
Thy lovely from alone I prize,
'Tis thou that canst impart
Continual pleasure to my eyes,
And gladness to my heart.*

Zardok

*Search round the word, there never yet was seen
So wise a monarch, or so chase a queen.*

CHORUS

*May no rash intruder disturb their soft hours;
To form fragrant pillows, arise, oh ye flow'rs!
Ye zephirs, soft-breathing, their slumbers prolong,
While nightingales lull them to sleep with their song.*

End of Part One**Intermission**

GEORGE FRIDERIC HANDEL (1685-1759)

SOLOMON • ACT II

Scene I

Solomon, Zadok, Levites and Israelites

CHORUS

*From the censer curling rise
Grateful incense to the skies;
Heaven blesses David's throne,
Happy, happy Solomon!
Live, live for ever, pious David's son;
Live, live for ever, mighty Solomon.*

Solomon

*Prais'd be the Lord, from Him my wisdom springs;
I bow in-raptur'd to the King of Kings.
He led me, abject, to th'imperial state,
When weak, and trembling for my future fate;
Strengthen'd by Him, each foe with horror fled,
Then impious Joab at the altar bled;
The death he oft deserv'd stern Shimei found,
And Adonijah sunk beneath the wound;
Forc'd by his crimes, I spoke a brother's doom, Ah may his
vices perish in his tomb!
When the sun o'er yonder hills
Pours in tides the golden day,
Or, when quiv'ring o'er the rills,
In the west he dies away;
He shall ever hear me sing
Praises to th'eternal King.*

Levite

*Great prince, thy resolution's just;
He never fails, in Heav'n who puts his trust,
True worth consists not in the pride of state,
'Tis virtue only makes a monarch great.
Thrice bless'd that wise discerning king,
Who can each passion tame,
And mount on virtue's eagle wing
To everlasting fame:
Such shall as mighty patterns stand
To princes yet unborn,
To honour prompt each distant land,
And future times adorn.
Thrice bless'd*

Scene II

*Solomon, Levite and Israelites
to them an Attendant*

Attendant

*My sovereign liege, two women stand,
And both beseech the king's command
To enter here. Dissolv'd in tears
the one a new-born infant bears;
The other, fierce, and threat'ning loud,
Declares her story to the crowd;
And thus she clamours to the throng,
"Seek we the king, he shall redress our wrong."*

Solomon

*Admit them straight; for when we mount the throne,
Our hours are all the people's, not our own.*

Scene III

To them the two harlots

First harlot

*Thou Son of David, hear a mother's grief;
And let the voice of justice bring relief.
This little babe my womb conceiv'd,
The smiling infant I with joy receiv'd.
That woman also bore a son,
Whose vital thread was quickly spun:
One house we both together kept;
But once, unhappy, as I slept,
She stole at midnight where I lay,
Bore my soft darling from my arms away,
And left her child behind, a lump of lifeless clay:
And now, oh impious! dares to claim
My right alone, a mother's name.*

TRIO

First harlot

*Words are weak to paint my fears;
Heart-felt anguish, starting tears,
Bet shall plead a mother's cause,
To thy throne, oh king, I bend,
My cause ist just, be thou my friend.*

Second harlot

False is all her melting tale.

Solomon

Justice holds the lifted scale.

Second harlot

Then be just, and fear the laws.

First harlot

*Words are weak to paint my fears;
Heart-felt anguish, starting tears,
Best shall plead a mother's cause.
To thy throne, oh king, I bend,
My cause is just, be thou my friend.*

Solomon

*What says the other to th'imputed charge?
Speak in thy turn, and tell thy wrongs at large.*

Second harlot

*I cannot varnish o'er my tongue,
And colour fair the face of wrong.
This babe is mine, the womb of earth
Intom'd, conceals her little birth.
Give me my child, my smiling boy,
To cheer my breast with new-born joy*

Solomon

*Hear me, ye women, and the king regard,
Who from his throne thus reads the just award:
Each claim alike, let both their portions share;
Divide the babe, thus each her part shall bear.
Quick, bring the faulchion, and the infant smite,
Nor further clamour for disputed right.*

Second harlot

*Thy sentence, great king,
Is prudent and wise,
And my hopes on the wring
Quick bound for the prize.
Contented I hear,
And approve the decree;
For at least I shall tear
The lov'd infant from thee.*

First harlot

*Withhold, withhold the executing hand!
Reverse, oh king, thy stern command.
Can I see my infant gor'd
With the fierce relentless sword?
Can I see him yield his breath,
Smiling at the hand of death?
And behold the purple tides
Gushing down his tender sides?
Rather be my hopes beguil'd,
Take him all - but spare my child.*

Solomon

*Israel, attend to what your king shall say;
Think not I meant the innocent to slay.
The stern decision was to trace with art,
The secret dictates of the human heart.
She who could bear the fierce decree to hear,
Nor send one sigh, nor shed one pious tear,
Must be a stranger to a mother's name.
Hence from my sight, nor urge a further claim!
But you, whose fears a parent's love attest,
Receive, and bind him to your beating breast;
To you, in justice, I the babe restore,
And may you lose him from your arms no more.*

First harlot

Thrice bless'd be the king, for he's good and he's wise;

Solomon

The Lord all these virtues has giv'n,

First harlot

My gratitude calls streaming tears from my eyes.

Solomon

*Thy thanks be return'd all to Heav'n.
'Tis god that rewards, and will lift from the dust
Whom to crush proud oppressors endeavour;*

First harlot

How happy are those who in God put their trust!

Solomon

For his mercy endureth for ever.

CHORUS OF ISRAELITES

*From the east unto the west,
Who so wise as Solomon?
Who like Israel's king is bless'd,
Who so worthy of a throne?*

Zadok

*From morn to eve I could enraptur'd sing
The various virtues of our happy king;
In whom, with wonder, we behold combin'd,
The grace of feature with the worth of mind.
See the tall palm that lifts the head
On Jordan's sedgy side,
His tow'ring branches curling spread,
And bloom in graceful pride.
Each meaner tree regardless springs,
Nor claims our scornful eyes;
Thus thou art first of mortal kings,
And wisest of the wise
See the tall palm: (da capo)*

First harlot

*The shepherd shall hail him all over the plain
and the soft eyed young virgin unite in the
strain..
Beneath the vine, or fig-tree's shade,
Ev'ry shepherd sings the maid,
Who his simple heart betray'd,
In a rustic measure.
While of torments he complains,
All around the village swains
Catch the song, and feel his pains,
Mingling sighs with pleasure.
Beneath the vine: (da capo)*

CHORUS OF PRIESTS

*Swell, swell the full chorus to Solomon's praise,
Record him, ye bards, as the pride of our days.
Flows sweetly the numbers that dwell on his name,
And rouse the whole nation in songs to his fame.
Swell, swell the full chorus: (da capo)*

End of Part Two

Intermission

GEORGE FRIDERIC HANDEL (1685-1759)

SOLOMON • ACT III

Scene I

Solomon, Queen of Sheb, Zadok and Chorus

Queen of Sheba

*From Arabia's spicy shores,
Bounded by the hoary main,
Sheba's queen these seats explores,
To be taught thy heav'nly strain.*

Solomon

*Thrice welcome queen, with open arms
Our court receives thee, and thy charms.
The temple of the Lord first meets your eyes,
Rich with the well-accepted sacrifice.
Here all our treasures free behold,
Where cedars lie, o'erwrought with gold;
Next, view a mansion fit for kings to own,
The forest call'd of tow'ring Lebanon,
Where art her utmost skill displays,
And ev'ry object claims your praise.*

Queen of Sheba

*Ev'ry sight these eyes behold,
Does a diff'rent charm unfold;
Flashing gems, and sculptur'd gold,
Still attract my ravish'd sight.
But to hear fair truth distilling,
In expressions choice and thrilling
From that tongue, so soft and killing,
That my soul does most delight.*

Solomon

*Sweep, sweep the string, to sooth the royal fair,
And rouse each passion with th'alternate air
Music apread thy voice around,
Sweetly flow the lulling sound.*

CHORUS

*Music apread thy voice around,
Sweetly flow the lulling sound.*

Solomon

*Now a diff'rent measure try,
Shake the dome, and pierce the sky.
Rouse us next to martial deeds;
Clanking arms, and neighing steeds,
Seem in fury to oppose
Now the hard-fought battle glows.*

CHORUS

*Shake the dome, and pierce the sky.
Rouse us next to martial deeds;
Clanking arms, and neighing steeds,
Seem in fury to oppose
Now the hard-fought battle glows.*

Solomon

*Then at once from rage remove;
Draw the tear from hopeless love;
Lengthen out the solemn air,
Full of death and wild despair.*

CHORUS

*Draw the tear from hopeless love;
Lengthen out the solemn air,
Full of death and wild despair.*

Solomon

*Next the tortur'd soul release,
And the mind restore to peace.
Thus rolling surges rise,
And plough the troubled main;
But soon the tempest dies,
And all is calm again.*

CHORUS

*Thus rolling surges rise, And
plough the troubled main; But
soon the tempest dies, And all
is calm again.*

Queen of Sheba

*Thy harmony's divine, great king,
All, all obeys the artist's string.
And now, illustrious prince, receive
Such tribute as my realm can give.
Here, purest gold, from earth's dark entrails torn;
And gems resplendent, that outshine the morn;
There balsam breathes a grateful smell,
With thee the fragrant strangers wish to dwell.
Yet of ev'ry object I behold,
Amid the glare of gems and gold,
The temple most attracts my eye,
Where, with unwearied zeal, you serve the Lord on high.*

Levite

*Pious king, and virtuous queen,
May your name resound in story;
In time's latest annals seen,
Crown'd with honour, crown'd with glory*

Zadok

Thrice happy king, to have achiev'd ,
 What scarce will henceforth be believ'd;
 When seven times around the sphere
 The sun had led the new-born year,
 The temple rose, to mark thy days
 With endless themes for future praise.
 Our pious David wish'd in vain,
 By this great act to bless his reign;
 But Heav'n the monarch's hopes withstood,
 For ah! His hands were stain'd with blood.
 Golden columns, fair and bright,
 Catch the mortals' ravish'd sight;
 Round their sides ambitious twine
 Tendrils of the clasping vine:
 Cherubims stand there display'd,

O'er the ark their wings are laid:
 Ev'ry object swells with state,
 All is pious, all is great.

CHORUS**Chorus 1**

Praise the Lord with harp and tongue!
 Praise Him all ye old and young,
 He's in mercy ever strong.

Chorus 2

Prais the Lord through ev'ry state,
 Praise Him early, praise him late,
 God alone is good and great.

Full Chorus

Let the loud Hosannahs rise,
 Widely spreading through the skies,
 God alone is just and wise.

Solomon

Gold now is common on our happy shore,
 And cedars frequent are as sycamore.
 All, all conspires to bless my days;
 Fair plenty does her treasures raise,
 And o'er the fruitful plains her countless gifts
 displays.
 How green our fertile pastures look!
 How fair our olive groves!
 How limpid is the gliding brook,
 That through the meadows roves.
 A hundred diff'rent balmy flow'rs
 Salute the passing gale,
 When ev'ning breezes fan the bow'rs,
 And sweep th'enamell'd vale.

Queen of Sheba

May peace in Salem ever dwell!
 Illustrious Solomon, farewell:
 Thy wise instructions be my future care,
 Soft as the show'rs that cheer the vernal air;
 Whose warmth bids ev'ry plant her sweets disclose,
 The lily wakes, and paints the op'ning rose.
 Will the sun forget to streak
 Eastern skies with amber ray,
 When the dusky shades to break
 He unbars the gates of day?
 Then demand if Sheba's queen
 E'er can banish from her thought
 All the splendor she has seen,
 All the knowledge thou hast taught.

Solomon

Adieu, fair queen, and in thy breast
 May peace and virtue ever rest!

DUET**Queen of Sheba**

Ev'ry joy that wisdom knows,
 May'st thou, pious monarch, share!

Solomon

Ev'ry blessing Heav'n bestows,
 Be thy portion, virtuous fair!

Queen of Sheba

Gently flow thy rolling day.

Solomon

Sorrow be stranger here.

Both

May thy people sound thy praise,
 Praise unbought by price or fear.

GRAND CHORUS

The name of the wicked shall quickly be past;
 But the fame of the just shall eternally last.

End of Part Performance

ABOUT THE CHORUS ABUJA

The Chorus Abuja is a classical ensemble dedicated to presenting distinguished performances of sacred, choral, and orchestral repertoire. We bring together passionate singers and instrumentalists who believe in the power of music to elevate, inspire, and transform our community.

APPRECIATION

The Chorus Abuja extends its deepest gratitude to everyone who made today's performance of *Handel's Solomon* possible. This concert stands as the result of dedication, artistry, generosity, and countless hours of unseen effort. We are profoundly grateful to all who contributed to its success.

To Our Volunteers, Media Team & Technical Crew

To our devoted volunteers, thank you for your tireless commitment—from organising rehearsals to ensuring the seamless coordination of today's event. Your cheerful service and reliability form the backbone of this choir.

To our media and technical teams—sound engineers, lighting crew, photographers, videographers, livestream operators, stage hands, and production assistants—your precision and professionalism elevated today's experience. You captured, shaped, and refined every moment with excellence.

To our accompanists, instrumentalists, and support personnel, your skill and discipline brought life to every note. Your artistry is a gift we deeply value.

To Our Audience, Guests & Supporters

To our esteemed guests, friends, families, and all lovers of classical and sacred music, thank you for honouring us with your presence. Your applause, encouragement, and belief in what we do inspire us to keep creating and offering music of depth and beauty.

To our partners, donors, and supporters—your generosity sustains us. Your financial, material, and moral support enable The Chorus Abuja to train young musicians, produce meaningful performances, and keep classical music thriving in our city.

We also express our sincere appreciation to the Nigerian Society of Engineers Hall for providing this beautiful space and for their cooperation throughout our preparations.

Your collective support strengthens our vision and fuels our growth.

Thank you for being part of this musical journey. We look forward to welcoming you again at our future performances.

Follow us and stay connected:

Instagram: @thechorus_abuja

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SUPPORT THE CHORUS ABUJA

Sponsorship & Donations Appeal

Thank you for joining us for this performance of Handel's *Solomon*. Every one of our concerts is the result of dedicated rehearsals, skilled musicianship, and a shared commitment to keeping classical choral music alive in Abuja.

As a community driven ensemble, **The Chorus Abuja receives no external funding**. Your support directly empowers our mission to produce high quality performances, train young musicians, acquire instruments and scores, and sustain our productions.

BECOME A SPONSOR

We invite individuals, businesses, and institutions to partner with us in building a thriving musical tradition.

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Email: sponsorship@thechorusabuja.org

Phone: 08032157688, 07036479579, 07062677022

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Every contribution—large or small—strengthens our mission.

Account Name: The Chorus Ensemble and Music Society

Bank: Zenith Bank

Account Number: 1229281261

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